Archiving Qualitative Online Sources

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QDR
QUALITATIVE DATA REPOSITORY

Online Sources in Social Science Research

- *Personal websites*
- *News sites*
- *Forums/Discussion groups*
- *Social Media*

Why Archive and Share Online Data

The Switch

Facebook takes down data and thousands of posts, obscuring reach of Russian disinformation

By Craig Timberg and Elizabeth Dwoskin October 12

- *Link rot*
  - *E.g.*
    - *>70% of the URLs in top law journals >50% of the URLs in SCOTUS decisions no longer accessible*
      Zittrain, Albert, and Lessig. 2014. https://doi.org/10.1017/S1472669614000255
    - *~80% of all URLs in 2008 American Political Science Review no longer accessible in 2016*
      Gertler and Bullock. 2017. https://doi.org/10.1017/S1049096516002353.

- *Integrated in data analysis, e.g. language processing or QDA analysis on corpus from web → reproducibility materials include online data*

Challenges of Sharing Online Sources: Technological

December 2017

Update on the Twitter Archive at the Library of Congress

(a) The nature of Twitter has changed over time.

i. The volume of tweets and related transactions has evolved and increased dramatically since the initial agreement was signed. Update on the Twitter Archive at the Library of Congress, December, 2017 2

ii. The Library only receives text. It does not receive images, videos or linked content. Tweets now are often more visual than textual, limiting the value of text-only collecting.

Challenges of Sharing Online Sources: Ethical (as small sampling…)

"Researchers should consider all attributes of the blog to assess the blogger's privacy intentions" (p. 360)

Eastham, Linda A. 2011. "Research Using Blogs for Data: Public Documents or Private Musings?" Research in Nursing & Health 34 (4): 353–61. https://doi.org/10.1002/nur.20443.

"While social media posts are available in public forums, social media users may not expect that their posts are being seen beyond their perceived online community (boyd, 2014). As Zimmer writes, "just because personal information is made available in some fashion on a social network,does not mean it is fair game for capture and release to all" (2010)."

Mannheimer, Sara, and Elizabeth A. Hull. 2018. "Sharing Selves: Developing an Ethical Framework for Curating Social Media Data." International Journal of Digital Curation 12 (2): 196–209. https://doi.org/10.2218/ijdc.v12i2.518.

Challenges of Sharing Online Sources: Legal

"What about copying, or "harvesting," publicly available Web sites? The law contains no specific exceptions for this type of copying, and its permissibility would likely depend on whether it qualified as fair use. (…) [T]here is no clear road under existing law for collecting the works proposed for a digital archive and placing them on a publicly accessible network."

Besek, June M. 2003. "Copyright Issues Relevant to the Creation of a Digital Archive: A Preliminary Assessmentbody." CLIR Report. Arlington, VA: Council on Library and Information Resources. https://www.clir.org/pubs/reports/pub112/body/.

The Twitter Developer Agreement (Twitter, 2014) states: 'if you provide Content to third parties, including downloadable datasets of Content or an API that returns Content, you will only distribute or allow download of Tweet IDs and/or User IDs'

Distinctive Characteristics of *Qualitative* Online Data

- *Manually collected:*
  - *Wide range of sources within single project*
  - *Typically no use of API*
- *Small(-ish) n: Individual assessment possible, e.g.*
  - *Creators' intent*
  - *Originality*
  - *Copyright / Fair use*
  - *Consent*

Case Study: Clarke (2018)

Volume 16, Issue 3 September 2018 , pp. 617-633

When Do the Dispossessed Protest? Informal Leadership and Mobilization in Syrian Refugee Camps

Killian Clarke

https://doi.org/10.1017/S1537592718001020 Published online: 21 August 2018

- *Supplementary Data to article in Perspectives on Politics,*
- *Why and when do refugees in camps/settlements protest? Common in Jordan, but not in Turkey and Lebanon*
- *UNHCR Reports, Socia Media "Event Data", Interviews (not shared)*

Clarke, Killian B. 2018. "Data for: When do the dispossessed protest? Informal leadership and mobilization in Syrian refugee camps". Qualitative Data Repository. https://doi.org/10.5064/F6CN723S

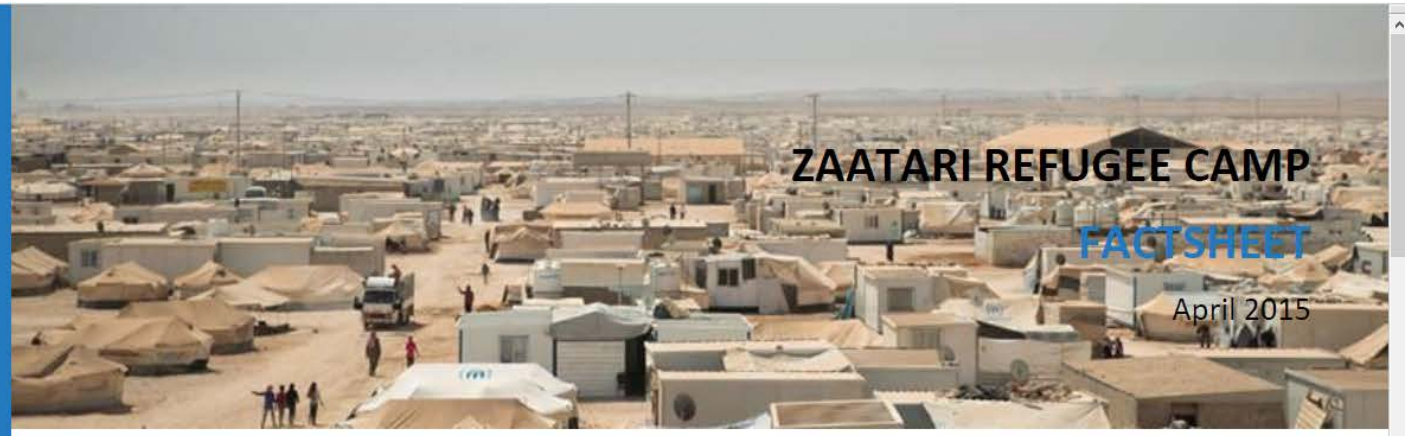
Clarke: Source Documents
UNHCR Reports

CCCM meeting in Za'atriDraft minutes of, UNHCR meeting room in registration
Tuesday 19th March, 14:00 hrs.
Chaired by Mr Kilian Kleinschmidt, Head of Zaatari Camp.

Agenda:

1. Agreement of minutes of the las
2. Security
3. Distribution
4. Participatory Assessment
5. Visitors/missions
6. AOB

UNHCR
The UN Refugee Agency



OVERVIEW

83,496 Persons of concern	50.3% Females, 49.7% Males	57% are youth, 19.9% are under 5 years old	1 in 5 households are headed by women	Average of 80 births per week.	Place of origin: Dara'a: 53.4%, Homs: 14.9%, Damascus: 7.5%, Hama: 4.4%.

Clarke: Source Documents Copyright?

- *UN and UNHCR documents are under copyright*
- *All documents retrieved from: https://data2.unhcr.org/en/situations*
- *Separate copyright statement (https://data2.unhcr.org/en/copyright/):*
  - *"Extracts of the information in this website may be reviewed, reproduced or translated for research or private study but not for sale or for use in conjunction with commercial purposes."*
- *Archiving critical as some documents (already) no longer available*
- *Usage conditions documented on QDR*

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Clarke: Event data (social media)

- *Relatively small number of mainly Twitter and Facebook posts reporting protest events, often with links to articles*

May 30, 2014	Tripoli	Protest	http://www.facebook.com/214836818613540_588984411198777	Dead
			http://www.twitter.com/BassamAbouZeid/status/472337328652812288	Dead
			http://www.twitter.com/Racha93halabi/status/472329273383329792	Good
May 31, 2014	Aarsal	Protest	https://now.mmedia.me/lb/en/archive/549447-syrian-refugees-in-arsal-protest-against-elections-of-death	Good
June 1, 2014	Khreibet Ej-Jind	Protest	http://www.twitter.com/LBCI_News_EN/status/473143975583313923	Good
			http://www.twitter.com/NewsLB/status/473131631008440320	Good
September 10, 2014	Nabatiyya	Protest	http://www.twitter.com/Live961/status/509709644655505408	Good
			http://www.twitter.com/Mulhak/status/509720449610022912	Good

Initially deposited version

Clarke: Event Data Challenges (Ethics, Copyright, Preservation)

LBCI Lebanon News EN
@LBCI_News_EN

Follow

Syrian nationals hold demonstration in support of #Assad in #Zahle | lbcgroup.tv /news/155969/LB... | #Syria #Lebanon

3:49 AM - 18 May 2014

Sharing Selves: Developing an Ethical Framework for Curating Social Media Data

Sara Mannheimer
Montana State University

Elizabeth A. Hull
Dryad Digital Repository

https://doi.org/10.2218/ijdc.v12i2.518

S Is the information being studied of a **sensitive** nature? Are the research subjects from vulnerable populations?

T Is there sufficient documentation to make the data reusable & collection methods **transparent**?

E Did subjects have an **expectation** of privacy? Was consent obtained for research and/or data sharing? Are the data properly anonymized, or can they be made so?

P Are the data in keeping with the policies of the social media **platform**?

May 18, 2014	Zahle	Protest	http://www.twitter.com/LBCI_News_EN/status/467950093274865664	Good	Syrian nationals hold demonstration in support of **#Assad** in **#Zahle** | https://www.lbcgroup.tv/news/155969/LBCI-News ... | **#Syria #Lebanon**

https://www.lbcgroup.tv/news/155969/LBCI-News	https://perma.cc/HH6H-3MAY

Tools: perma.cc & Internet Archive

- *Both provide archiving capabilities for web content*
- *IA*
  - *Free to use*
  - *Large existing archive (WayBackMachine)*
  - *No proper API for archiving*
- *Perma.cc*
  - *Archiving requires payment of membership through library*
  - *Archiving via API*
  - *Screenshots and*

Case: Syrian Civil War

Wedeen, Lisa. Forthcoming 2019. "Data for: Authoritarian apprehensions: Ideology, judgment, and mourning in Syria." Qualitative Data Repository.

> *"What led a sizable part of the citizenry to stick by the regime through one atrocity after another? What happens to political judgment in a context of pervasive misinformation? And what might the Syrian example suggest about how authoritarian leaders exploit digital media to create uncertainty, political impasses, and fractures among their citizenries?"*

- *Hundreds of online sources used throughout text*
- *Many of them video (Youtube, Vimeo, etc.)*
- *Additionally, videos from Syrian TV licensed for copyright*

Tool: archivr

- *R-tool developed by QDR*
- *Scans text (or spreadsheet) extracts URLs*
- *Option to archive using IA or perma.cc*
- *Returns list with original URLs and archived URLs (or error)*
- *https://github.com/QualitativeDataRepository/archivr/*

Tool: Webrecorder.io

"Webrecorder is both a tool to create high-fidelity, interactive recordings of any web site you browse and a platform to make those recordings accessible."

- *Used by QDR to make videos and other non-static formats available*
- *Allows for publish sharing of collections (similar to IA/perma.cc)*

General Lessons

- *Sharing qualitative online data faces the same challenges as sharing larger-scale web data*
- *However, given the smaller number of items, individual curation & checks are feasible, allowing for more sharing*
- *There is a trade-off to "outsourcing" archiving to services such as perma.cc and webrecorder.io, but both the technical and legal benefits outweigh the risks*
- *Especially for larger scale efforts, further tools are available from Documenting the Now: https://www.docnow.io/*

Questions? Comments?

Please stay in touch:
https://qdr.syr.edu

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